

Power BI Tour

30-Minute Hands-On Exercise | Week 9 - Section 1B

Learning Objectives: Navigate the Power BI Desktop interface | Identify ribbon tabs and the views where each is available | Distinguish the four views and their purposes | Apply knowledge of the interface to real analyst workflows

Instructions: Complete all four parts in 30 minutes. Refer to your Section 1B notes. Be ready to discuss your answers with the class.

Part 1: Fill in the Blank (~7 minutes)

Complete each sentence with the correct term from Section 1B.

1.	Microsoft recommends always being on the <u>latest</u> version of Power BI to avoid file-sharing compatibility issues.
2.	To check your installed version of Power BI Desktop, navigate to the <u>Help</u> tab.
3.	Within the Help tab, select <u>About</u> to view the installed version number.
4.	The control that lets you switch between Power BI's four workspaces is called the <u>View Selector</u> .
5.	Power BI Desktop has <u>four</u> distinct views that each offer a different workspace and set of ribbon options.
6.	To manage which project you are working with and access Options and Settings, use the <u>File tab</u> .

Part 2: Matching (~6 minutes)

Write the letter of the correct description next to each Power BI view or ribbon tab.

Item	Description
A. Report View 2.	1. Appears only when a specific report component is selected; offers contextual formatting actions
B. Table View 6.	2. Used to design and view visual report elements such as charts, cards, and slicers
C. Model View 4.	3. Allows you to query the semantic model using DAX language, similar to querying a DB with SQL

D. DAX Query View	3.	4. Used to configure and visualize the relationships between datasets in the model
E. Insert Tab	5.	5. Only available in Report View; contains items that can be inserted into a report page
F. Format Tab	1.	6. Lets you view raw data in its tables and modify columns via the ribbon or right-click menus

Part 3: Ribbon Availability Chart (~8 minutes)

Place a checkmark (✓) in each cell where the ribbon tab is available for that view. Leave the cell blank if it is NOT available. Use your Section 1B notes.

Ribbon Tab	Report View	Table View	Model View	DAX Query View
Home	yes	yes	yes	yes
Insert	yes			
Modeling	yes			
View	yes			
Format	yes			
Data / Drill	yes			
Table Tools	yes	yes		
Help	yes	yes	yes	

Part 4: Short Answer (~9 minutes)

Answer each question in 2-4 sentences in your own words.

Question 1

You open Power BI Desktop for the first time and land on the Home Screen. Name three things you can do from the Home Screen without using the ribbon.

From the Home Screen you can start a brand new blank report project, quickly open a recent project you've worked on before, and jump directly into recommended training content that Microsoft provides. All three of these are accessible right from the Home Screen without needing to touch the ribbon at all.

Question 2

Your instructor asks you to create a new bar chart on a blank report page. Which view would you be in, and which ribbon tabs might you use? Explain why each is relevant.

You would be in Report View since that's the only view where you can design and place visual elements on the canvas. You'd use the Insert tab to add a new blank bar chart visual to the page, the Visualizations pane to configure what data fields go on the axes, and the Format tab once the chart is selected to adjust colors, labels, and styling. The Data/Drill tab might also be useful if you want to explore drill-down behavior on the chart.

Question 3

A teammate notices that the Modeling tab has disappeared from the ribbon. What is the most likely reason, and what should they do to get it back?

The most likely reason is that they switched out of Report View — the Modeling tab is only available in Report View. They should click the Report View icon in the View Selector on the left side of the screen to switch back, and the Modeling tab will reappear in the ribbon automatically.

Question 4

How does the DAX Query View differ from the Table View? In what situation would you choose to use DAX Query View instead?

Table View shows you the raw data already loaded into your model in a grid/spreadsheet format — you're just browsing what's there. DAX Query View, on the other hand, lets you write actual DAX queries to actively interrogate and explore the semantic model, similar to how you'd write SQL queries against a database. You'd choose DAX Query View when you want to test or troubleshoot a DAX expression, verify what a measure returns, or explore calculated results before committing them to the model.

Bonus / Reflection (if time allows)

The Power BI ribbon changes depending on which view is active and what is selected on screen. In 3-5 sentences, explain why Microsoft designed the interface this way. What benefit does a context-sensitive ribbon provide to a data analyst?
